

1 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Pack for a pretend outing

What we are practising

Plan ahead and explain choices using a situation's needs.

What you need

Light bag / Hat / Empty water bottle / Book / Small towel / Large toy

Draw items and circle what to pack.

Before you begin

Choose an imaginary short park visit with an adult on a sunny day.

Use an empty bottle and light bag; an adult chooses real travel, weather and sun protection arrangements.

Try it together

1. Describe the outing and inspect the available items.
2. Choose three items and explain a use for each.
3. Change the outing to an indoor library visit and revise the choices.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which choice changed when our destination changed?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Two builders, one favourite block

What we are practising

State a need, hear another person and propose a workable agreement.

What you need

Two soft toys / One large block

Tell the scene using two drawn characters.

Before you begin

Explain that both characters want the same block for their building.

An adult models supportive language, stays nearby and lets the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Give each character a sentence: "I need this for my roof."
2. Suggest two solutions, such as taking turns or building together.
3. Act out one agreement and check whether both characters can continue.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How can both builders know when a turn ends?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Practise a zip and a button

What we are practising

Follow and describe steps in a self-care task.

What you need

Clean garment with a sturdy zip / Garment with a large securely sewn button

Practise only the fastener available; an adult may hold the fabric.

Before you begin

Lay garments flat and check for loose buttons, damaged teeth or rough edges.

Use intact fasteners; remove any garment with a loose button. Keep skin and hair clear of zips.

Try it together

1. Hold the zip's base steady and move the pull slowly on an already joined zip.
2. For a button, find its matching hole and tilt one edge through first.
3. Take turns describing and trying each step, stopping before frustration grows.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which hand can steady the fabric while the other moves?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Make a clear help request

What we are practising

Describe a problem and make a specific request.

What you need

No materials

Point, gesture or use a picture as part of the request.

Before you begin

Choose an everyday pretend problem, such as a stuck pencil-case zip.

An adult models supportive language, stays nearby and lets the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Model: "My pencil case will not open. Can you help me with the zip?"
2. Let the child practise in their own words or gestures.
3. Try another scenario, such as not understanding an activity instruction, and respond helpfully.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What detail helps the adult understand the problem?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 20 minutes

Plan a family mini-project

What we are practising

Plan an order, agree responsibilities and review a shared result.

What you need

Paper / Pencils / A few books

Plan a shared drawing station instead of a reading corner.

Before you begin

Choose a small project: set up a comfortable floor reading corner.

An adult chooses a clear floor space; children carry only light items and never move furniture or climb shelves.

Try it together

1. Draw three jobs: clear a small space, bring two books, make a welcome sign.
2. Agree who does each job and which should happen first.
3. Complete the jobs, check the list together and change one thing to make the corner easier to use.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which jobs can happen together and which need to wait?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Pack for a pretend outing

A little hint

Ask what you plan to do and what you might need while doing it.

Answer / what to notice

Several sets can work if choices have sensible uses; the adult remains responsible for real outing preparation.

A useful plan changes when the setting or purpose changes.

Make it easier

Choose between two items for one stated need.

Take it further

Make a picture checklist and check the packed bag against it.

Another day, away from the screen

Help an adult prepare one item for the next real outing.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Two builders, one favourite block

A little hint

Use a clear event, such as finishing one small house, rather than “later”.

Answer / what to notice

A workable agreement is clear and accepted by both; an adult can help if no agreement is possible.

Naming needs and specific next steps gives people something concrete to negotiate.

Make it easier

Choose between two adult-modelled solutions.

Take it further

Show why a vague promise may fail, then improve it.

Another day, away from the screen

Try an agreed turn rule during a shared drawing.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Practise a zip and a button

A little hint

Practise on the table before trying a garment being worn.

Answer / what to notice

Any comfortable method that closes the fastener without force is useful; partial success counts.

Separating a task into stabilising and moving steps makes its parts easier to notice.

Make it easier

An adult starts the movement and the child finishes.

Take it further

Try starting a separating zip with adult help.

Another day, away from the screen

Choose one dressing step to practise when there is no rush.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Make a clear help request

A little hint

Name what happened, then what you need.

Answer / what to notice

A useful request communicates a need; perfect sentences, eye contact or a particular polite phrase are not required.

Specific information helps another person offer suitable help.

Make it easier

Complete “Please help me with...” or point to the problem.

Take it further

Practise clarifying when the adult misunderstands the first request.

Another day, away from the screen

Identify trusted adults the child can approach in familiar settings.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Plan a family mini-project

A little hint

The space should be ready before setting books in it.

Answer / what to notice

Several role arrangements work; a clear order and reachable shared result matter.

A short checklist makes responsibilities and unfinished steps visible.

Make it easier

Use two jobs and complete them side by side.

Take it further

Let the child lead the final check and suggest one improvement.

Another day, away from the screen

Use a picture checklist for another small family project.